

Wing is candidate for UTEP baseball post

University of Arizona assistant baseball coach Jim Wing is among several candidates for the head coaching job at Texas-El Paso.

Wing and UTEP Athletic Director Jim Bowden discussed the Miner position when the Wildcats traveled to El Paso three weeks ago.

The job became available when UTEP's baseball coach of 16 years, Andy Cohen, announced his retirement from coaching recently.

The 73-year-old Cohen played three years for the New York Giants and held several managerial jobs before he accepted the Miner position in 1963. His record at UTEP is 300-353 including a 26-26 record this season.

"We'll be accepting applications for the next two weeks," said UTEP Sports Information Director Scott Binning. "Right now, they're deciding what to do with the position. They combine it with something else — a teaching position or something. Andy was

not full salaried. He literally donated his time."

Wing, who is in his sixth year as assistant to Wildcat head coach Jerry Kindall, joined the UA staff after a highly successful stint as head man at Palo Verde High School.

The Titan teams under Wing compiled a record of 162-73 in eight years. Palo Verde won its league title three straight years under Wing.

A graduate of Arizona in 1958, Wing also

was a junior varsity coach at Tucson High for five years and compiled an impressive coaching record in Tucson summer leagues.

His 1963 American Legion team was the state champion and in 1964 he coached the Legion runner-up.

Wing enrolled at the UA in 1954 and earned his freshman letter as a catcher, but a shoulder injury prevented him from playing full time on the varsity.

Wing and his wife, Bess, have three children, Mike, 18, Marc, 15, and Jamie, 12.